Protocol design elements and USDM

Data or words?

What USDM holds for objectives, endpoints, eligibility criteria and the schedule

Kerstin Forsberg · based on the published USDM v4 model

The question

For each design element: which parts are data, and which are still words?

EXAMPLE · AN OBJECTIVE IN USDM

Level: primary | Its endpoints, linked

The objective itself, as a sentence written in the protocol

Data

Choices from a list, numbers, links. A system can check and reuse them.

Words

Sentences and written rules. A person has to read them.

Five design elements: the schedule is data, the rest is mostly words

Blue: data

Orange: words

Objective

Level | Its endpoints

The objective, written

Endpoint

Level | The endpoint, written

Its purpose

Eligibility criterion

Inclusion or exclusion | Order

The criterion, written

Label like “I1”

no link in USDM

Schedule of activities

Activities | at visits | timing and windows | visit type, contact mode | what is measured

Conditions for branching | Visit start and end rules

Arms × epochs

element	element	element
element	element	element

Inside each element: what happens, start rule, end rule

In short

USDM gives every design element an identity. Much of the content is still words.

Held as data	The schedule of activities, and the arm and epoch grid
Held as words	Objectives, endpoints, eligibility criteria, and the rules inside elements
Not held	Endpoint to assessments, and design element to protocol section

Based on the published USDM v4 model. The detailed analysis, attribute by attribute, is public at kerfors.github.io/usdm-overlay